



Sociology

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · ONE SEMESTER ·
½ CREDIT · ELECTIVE

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in topics, communities studied, and activities from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Sociology introduces scholars to how people create meaning, organize communities, and influence one another within social systems. Scholars examine social structures, cultural patterns, and how individuals both shape and are shaped by the groups they belong to. Through studying diverse societies and communities, past and present, scholars develop understanding of how beliefs, values, and behaviors emerge from social context, and they learn to recognize their own assumptions and see perspectives different from their own. Using immersive VR and AI-enhanced learning, scholars explore different communities and social dynamics. They work with primary and secondary sources, use sociological research methods to weigh evidence, and reason carefully about the social questions that shape everyday life.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 The Sociological Perspective (strand)

The development of sociology as a social science, its early theorists, how it compares with other social sciences, and the research methods used to study social life.

3 Social Structure, Groups, and Institutions (strand)

Status, roles, and role conflict; how social groups function; norms, deviance, and social control; and how institutions transmit the values of a society.

5 Social Change and Collective Behavior (strand)

How and why societies change over time, the role of technology and the media, and the impact of social movements and collective behavior on community development.

2 Culture and Society (strand)

The key components of culture, the difference between culture and society, subcultures and cultural diversity, and how different types of societies compare.

4 Social Issues and Inequality (strand)

Identifying social problems, examining causes such as poverty and discrimination, distinguishing fact from opinion, and evaluating societal responses.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Study of primary and secondary sources most days, with text-based discussion of social life.
- Sociological research methods: gathering data, distinguishing fact from opinion, and weighing evidence.
- Evidence-based writing and reasoning about communities, culture, and social change.
- Immersive VR and AI-supported activities, plus research and presentation tasks, where they fit.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday, for one semester

- Reading, discussion, and writing fill most of the scheduled time.
- Research and project weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A notebook for notes, sources, and reasoning.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for written work.
- Access to Optima's VR campus for immersive activities.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, when offered live; for 2026–27 Sociology is listed as an On-Demand course.